

Title

Efficacy and Safety Comparison of Novel Systemic Therapies in Moderate Psoriasis: Study Protocol

Abstract

Background: Systemic treatment options for moderate plaque psoriasis continue to expand, yet comparative effectiveness data guide clinical decision-making. **Methods:** This 52-week, phase IV, randomized, open-label comparative effectiveness trial will evaluate two distinct systemic approaches in patients with moderate chronic plaque psoriasis. Approximately 360 adults (aged ≥ 18 years) with ≥ 6 months psoriasis duration and candidacy for systemic therapy will be enrolled. Participants will be randomized 1:2 to receive either subcutaneous injections of an IL-23-pathway inhibitor or daily oral phosphodiesterase-4 inhibitor. Primary outcomes at 16 weeks will be achievement of $\geq 90\%$ skin clearance and physician-rated complete or nearly-complete clearing with ≥ 2 -grade improvement. At 16 weeks, those receiving the oral agent will be re-randomized based on treatment response, allowing comparison of switching strategies. Secondary outcomes include sustained response at 52 weeks, safety/adverse event profiles, treatment satisfaction, and quality-of-life measures. This pragmatic comparative effectiveness design will provide real-world efficacy and safety data to inform treatment selection.